# Roman Zaiev

Senior Software Engineer | Technical Founder
15 years of professional experience

London, GB (settled, no visa required)
roman@zaiev.net · linkedin.com/in/zaiev
github.com/zaiev · hypha.pub

Software engineer with 15 years of experience designing and building production systems end-to-end — from high-load e-commerce platforms and fintech infrastructure to an early-stage video platform with on-chain payments.

Known for building systems that are simple, elegant, and reliable for the long run.

I operate best in environments that value technical depth, vision and ownership, alongside talented and self-motivated people on problems that matter.

Looking for a senior engineering role with room to grow and long-term impact.

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LANGUAGES
English (C1) · Ukrainian (native) · Russian (native)
Python (expert) · JavaScript & TypeScript · Familiar with Rust, Go, OCaml, Clojure

STACK
FastAPI · PostgreSQL · Redis · DuckDB
Solid.js · React · HTMX
FreeBSD / Jails · Linux / Docker / K8s
Ansible · Terraform · CI/CD · AWS / GCP
Solana · Anchor (smart contracts)

PROJECTS
Hypha — video platform with non-custodial economy

TALKS
Stop Using ORMs // PyCon LT 2026
Rethinking the Stack // PyCon Wrocław 2025
API-centric Web Development with Tornado // Kyiv IT Weekend 2015

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## Experience

AUG 2025 – NOW

### Hypha Technologies Ltd – London, GB

*Founder & CTO*

Designed and built a complete video-on-demand platform end-to-end — backend, frontend, payments, data processing pipelines, and infrastructure.

Implemented non-custodial on-chain payments using Solana smart contracts for instant settlement and no intermediary.

Built encrypted streaming and 4K HDR transcoding pipeline with efficient video fingerprinting.

Designed custom bare-metal infrastructure on FreeBSD for performance and cost efficiency (case study under discussion with FreeBSD Foundation).

Currently onboarding early creators, mentoring engineers, and consulting while refining the platform's economy.

Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, TimescaleDB, Redis, DuckDB, Solana, Anchor, Solid.js, HTMX, SSE, FreeBSD / Jails, Ansible

OCT 2022 — DEC 2024

## Revolut – London, GB

*Software Engineer — Experimentation Platform*

Designed and built the core infrastructure for Revolut's Experimentation Platform, adopted as the company-wide standard across product and ML teams. Replaced fragmented A/B tooling with a unified, scalable system. Built SDKs and abstractions to reduce complexity and accelerate adoption by product teams.

Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Trino, Kubernetes, Pandas

FEB 2022 — SEP 2022

*Software Engineer — Retail Data Science*

Core contributor to the design and implementation of Revolut's Feature Store — a centralized system for managing ML features across Data Science teams. Delivered multiple proofs of concept that shaped the production architecture.

Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Trino, Kubernetes, Airflow

DEC 2019 — JAN 2022

*Software Engineer — Risks*

Built and maintained backend services and backoffice tooling for multiple internal Risk systems, owned end-to-end across Python backend and React/TypeScript frontend.

Python, Flask, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, React, TypeScript

FEB 2017 — AUG 2019

## Nextiva – Kyiv, UA / Scottsdale, USA

*Software Engineer — Rules Engine*

Designed and built a core app and DSL for defining rule conditions — foundation of Nextiva's Rules Engine. Its scheduling library released as the company's first open-source project.

Python, asyncio, aiohttp, RabbitMQ, gRPC, Protobuf, PostgreSQL

NOV 2015 — NOV 2016

## B2B Soft – Kyiv, UA / New York, USA

*Software Engineer & Tech Lead*

Led design and delivery of a greenfield medical platform from the ground up.

Python, Tornado, React, Redux, Kafka, MongoDB, Sphinx, Ansible, AWS

MAR 2015 — NOV 2015

## SoftServe – Kyiv, UA / San Jose, USA

*Software Engineer*

Built telemetry aggregation systems for Cisco Cloud Services.

Python, Logstash, MongoDB, RabbitMQ, OpenStack

FEB 2014 — MAR 2015

## Kasta – Kyiv, UA

*Software Engineer, Head of Platform Development*

Designed and delivered the MVP of a high-load e-commerce successor platform.

Python, Tornado, Elasticsearch, ZeroMQ, Protobuf, PostgreSQL

AUG 2013 — JAN 2014

## GetGoing – Kyiv, UA / San Francisco, USA

*Software Engineer*

Implemented airline seat selection system for a travel startup integrated with Amadeus GDS.

Python, Django, PostgreSQL, Celery, Elasticsearch, Backbone.js

NOV 2012 — AUG 2013

## Prom – Kyiv, UA

*Backend Developer*

Internal services and CRM maintenance, data processing, and third-party API integrations.

Python, Pylons, SQLAlchemy, Celery